THE HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION

HARAPPAN CHRONOLOGY: REGIONAL ROOTS → HARAPPAN SPATIAL SYSTEM AND → URBAN-RURAL SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY → BUILT ORDER, WATER AND → THE HARAPPAN ECONOMY AS → INTERNAL AND OVERSEAS EXCHANGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 HARAPPAN CHRONOLOGY: REGIONAL ROOTS TO LOCALISATION

HARAPPAN CHRONOLOGY · REGIONAL ROOTS TO LOCALISATION · LATE/LOCALISATION C. 3300-2600 BCE C. 2600-1900 BCE C. 1900-1300 · INTEGRATED URBAN-RURAL NETWORK; DECLINE · REGIONAL TRANSFORMATION.

EARLY/REGIONALISATION → MATURE/INTEGRATION → LATE/LOCALISATION c. → 3300-2600 BCE c. → 2600-1900 BCE c. → 1900-1300 BCE regional towns/crafts shared weights, seals, de-urbanisation, local ceramics, and exchange networks script, urban. → Civilisation = integrated urban-rural network; decline = regional transformation.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE
- EARLY/REGIONALISATION → MATURE/INTEGRATION → LATE/LOCALISATION c.
- 3300-2600 BCE c.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION
- 2600-1900 BCE c.
- 1900-1300 BCE regional towns/crafts shared weights, seals, de-urbanisation, local ceramics, and exchange networks script, urban systems settlement shifts,

IMPACT / LIMIT
- Civilisation = integrated urban-rural network; decline = regional transformation.
- EARLY/REGIONALISATION → MATURE/INTEGRATION → LATE/LOCALISATION c.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Civilisation = integrated urban-rural network; decline = regional transformation.

01 HARAPPAN SPATIAL SYSTEM AND SITE ATLAS

HARAPPAN SPATIAL SYSTEM AND SITE ATLAS · MAKRAN EDGE · JAMMU FRONTIER · CORE INDUS · URBAN/CEMETERY SEQUENCE · GREAT BATH/DRAINS · PLOUGHED FIELD/FIRE INSTALLATIONS · FORTIFIED TOWN

WEST: Sutkagendor → Makran edge

NORTH: Manda → Jammu frontier → CORE INDUS: Harappa → urban/cemetery sequence → Mohenjo-daro → Great Bath/drains

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- WEST: Sutkagendor → Makran edge
- NORTH: Manda → Jammu frontier
- CORE INDUS: Harappa → urban/cemetery sequence
- Mohenjo-daro → Great Bath/drains
- GHAGGAR: Kalibangan → ploughed field/fire installations

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- Banawali → fortified town
- EAST: Rakhigarhi → major Haryana complex
- Alamgirpur → eastern Late Harappan edge
- KUTCH: Dholavira → three-part city, reservoirs, signboard
- Surkotada → fortification

DEBATE / LEGACY
- GUJARAT: Lothal → basin/warehouse/craft debate
- Rangpur → regional sequence
- SINDH: Chanhudaro → craft centre; no classic citadel-lower-town profile

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SINDH: Chanhudaro → craft centre; no classic citadel-lower-town profile.

02 URBAN-RURAL SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY

URBAN-RURAL SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY · FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS · CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES · REGIONAL CITIES FOOD AND HERDS STORAGE SPECIALISED OUTPUT COORDINATION/CONSUMPTION · URBANISM DEPENDED ON RURAL SURPLUS AND RAW-MATERIAL CORRIDORS; CITIES

FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS → VILLAGES → CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES → REGIONAL CITIES food and herds storage specialised

output coordination/consumption weights + seals + transport + shared styles connect unequal regional domains. → Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS → VILLAGES → CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES → REGIONAL CITIES food and herds storage specialised
- output coordination/consumption weights + seals + transport + shared styles connect unequal regional domains.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.
- FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS → VILLAGES → CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES → REGIONAL CITIES food and herds storage specialised

DEBATE / LEGACY
- output coordination/consumption weights + seals + transport + shared styles connect unequal regional domains.
- Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.

03 BUILT ORDER, WATER AND CIVIC MAINTENANCE

BUILT ORDER, WATER AND CIVIC MAINTENANCE · PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD · BATHING AREAS · COVERED DRAINS · SOAK PITS/INSPECTION ACCESS HOUSEHOLD INVESTMENT COLLECTIVE MAINTENANCE · DHOLAVIRA ADAPTS RESERVOIRS TO ARIDITY: MOHENJO-DARO STRESSES WELLS AND

PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD HOUSES wells/reservoirs → bathing → areas → covered drains → soak pits/inspection access household investment collective maintenance → Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD HOUSES wells/reservoirs → bathing
- areas → covered drains → soak pits/inspection access household investment collective maintenance

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.
- PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD HOUSES wells/reservoirs → bathing

DEBATE / LEGACY
- areas → covered drains → soak pits/inspection access household investment collective maintenance
- Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.

04 THE HARAPPAN ECONOMY AS A LINKED SYSTEM

THE HARAPPAN ECONOMY AS A LINKED SYSTEM · AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE WHEAT/BARLEY CATTLE COTTON FISHING/REGIONAL CROPS · CRAFT WORKSHOPS · CALIBRATED WEIGHTS · BEADS, SHELL, FAIENCE, POTTERY, COPPER/BRONZE; STONE REMAINS IMPORTANT.

AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE wheat/barley cattle cotton fishing/regional crops

SURPLUS → craft workshops → calibrated weights → seals/transport → exchange → CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE wheat/barley cattle cotton fishing/regional crops
- SURPLUS → craft workshops → calibrated weights → seals/transport → exchange

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.
- AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE wheat/barley cattle cotton fishing/regional crops

DEBATE / LEGACY
- SURPLUS → craft workshops → calibrated weights → seals/transport → exchange
- CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.

05 INTERNAL AND OVERSEAS EXCHANGE CORRIDORS

INTERNAL AND OVERSEAS EXCHANGE CORRIDORS · RAW MATERIAL FLOW · INDUS CITIES · COPPER CORRIDOR · PRODUCTION ZONES · SHELL, CARNELIAN, COASTAL ROUTES · CRAFTS AND PORTS · MESOPOTAMIA; MELUHHA IN CUNEIFORM TEXTS

RAW MATERIAL FLOW

Baluchistan/Afghanistan → metals/stones → Indus cities → Rajasthan/Khetri → copper corridor → production zones → Gujarat/Kutch → shell, carnelian, coastal routes → crafts and ports

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- RAW MATERIAL FLOW
- Baluchistan/Afghanistan → metals/stones → Indus cities
- Rajasthan/Khetri → copper corridor → production zones

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- Gujarat/Kutch → shell, carnelian, coastal routes → crafts and ports
- Indus/Makran/Gulf → Dilmun/Magan → Mesopotamia; Meluhha in cuneiform texts
- Trade evidence = imports + texts + seals + production; it does not prove colonies.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- Lothal basin has dockyard/reservoir interpretations: state the debate.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Lothal basin has dockyard/reservoir interpretations: state the debate.

06 SOCIETY AND POLITY: EVIDENCE WITHOUT INVENTED KINGS

SOCIETY AND POLITY · EVIDENCE WITHOUT INVENTED KINGS · HOUSE VARIATION + SCARCE GOODS + CRAFT CONTROL + · NO SECURE PALACE, ROYAL TOMB OR DECIPHERED KING-LIST: HIERARCHY · COORDINATED INSTITUTIONS ARE CERTAIN; EMPIRE-LEVEL SOVEREIGNTY IS UNPROVEN.

SOURCE / MATERIAL
- EVIDENCE: house variation + scarce goods + craft control + standards + public works centralised state?
- city/regional states?

METHOD / DEBATE
- corporate or mercantile elites?
- NO secure palace, royal tomb or deciphered king-list: hierarchy existed, form is open.

HISTORICAL RESULT
- VERDICT: coordinated institutions are certain; empire-level sovereignty is unproven.
- EVIDENCE: house variation + scarce goods + craft control + standards + public works centralised state?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: coordinated institutions are certain; empire-level sovereignty is unproven.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: coordinated institutions are certain; empire-level sovereignty is unproven.

07 SCRIPT, SEALS AND RELIGION: EVIDENCE LADDER

SCRIPT, SEALS AND RELIGION · EVIDENCE LADDER · SHORT SIGNS, SEALS/TABLETS, MOTIFS, RITUAL INSTALLATIONS, BURIALS, FIGURINES · IDENTITY/TRANSACTION MARKING AND DIFFERENTIATED RITUAL PRACTICES · SCRIPT LANGUAGE; PROTO-SHIVA; MOTHER-GODDESS SYSTEM; UNIVERSAL FIRE ALTARS · READING LATER HINDU DOCTRINE DIRECTLY INTO EVERY HARAPPAN IMAGE. · UNDECIPHERED SCRIPT BLOCKS DIRECT ACCESS TO OFFICE, BELIEF AND · USE OBJECT + CONTEXT + DISTRIBUTION BEFORE ANALOGY.

SOURCE / MATERIAL
- SECURE: short signs, seals/tablets, motifs, ritual installations, burials, figurines
- PROBABLE: identity/transaction marking and differentiated ritual practices

METHOD / DEBATE
- DISPUTED: script language; proto-Shiva; mother-goddess system; universal fire altars
- REJECT: reading later Hindu doctrine directly into every Harappan image.

HISTORICAL RESULT
- Undeciphered script blocks direct access to office, belief and political vocabulary.
- Use object + context + distribution before analogy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use object + context + distribution before analogy.

08 DE-URBANISATION: INTERACTING REGIONAL CAUSES

INTERACTING REGIONAL CAUSES · RIVER SHIFTS/FLOODS + ARIDIFICATION + EXCHANGE CONTRACTION + MAINTENANCE · CITY CONTRACTION/ABANDONMENT · SETTLEMENT REDISTRIBUTION LOSS · SCRIPT, SEALS, LARGE CITIES CONTINUITY · CROPS, CRAFTS, VILLAGES · NO INVASION OR SINGLE RIVER EXPLAINS ALL REGIONS; TIMINGS

river shifts/floods + aridification + exchange contraction + maintenance stress weaker standards → city → contraction/abandonment → settlement redistribution loss: script, seals, large cities continuity: crops, crafts, villages. → No invasion or single river explains all regions; timings and outcomes differ.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- river shifts/floods + aridification + exchange contraction + maintenance stress weaker standards → city
- contraction/abandonment → settlement redistribution loss: script, seals, large cities continuity: crops, crafts, villages

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- No invasion or single river explains all regions; timings and outcomes differ.
- river shifts/floods + aridification + exchange contraction + maintenance stress weaker standards → city

DEBATE / LEGACY
- contraction/abandonment → settlement redistribution loss: script, seals, large cities continuity: crops, crafts, villages
- No invasion or single river explains all regions; timings and outcomes differ.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No invasion or single river explains all regions; timings and outcomes differ.

09 HARAPPAN ANSWER ARCHITECTURE: 10/15/20 MARKS

HARAPPAN ANSWER ARCHITECTURE · 10/15/20 MARKS · 10 MARKS · SITE-FEATURE TRIAD · INTERPRETATION CAUTION · 15 MARKS · SPATIAL SYSTEM · URBAN FORM

10 MARKS: phase → site-feature triad → mechanism → interpretation caution → 15 MARKS: chronology → spatial system → urban form → economy → polity/religion limits → 20 MARKS: integration → site map → urban-rural economy → water/standards/trade → society-polity evidence → script/ritual limits → transformation → BENCHMARK: material uniformity indicates integration, not automatic political unity.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- 10 MARKS: phase → site-feature triad → mechanism → interpretation caution
- 15 MARKS: chronology → spatial system → urban form → economy → polity/religion limits

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- 20 MARKS: integration → site map → urban-rural economy → water/standards/trade
- society-polity evidence → script/ritual limits → transformation

DEBATE / LEGACY
- BENCHMARK: material uniformity indicates integration, not automatic political unity.
- CLOSE: a varied civilisation coordinated by standards, exchange and maintenance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: a varied civilisation coordinated by standards, exchange and maintenance.

10 EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · 1. SEPARATE EXCAVATED FACT FROM FUNCTION LABEL AND SOCIAL · 2. ANCHOR EVERY CLAIM IN SITE, PHASE, CONTEXT, COMPARISON · 3. THE UNDECIPHERED SCRIPT LIMITS NAMED CLAIMS ABOUT LANGUAGE · HARAPPAN HISTORY IS STRONGEST ON MATERIAL SYSTEMS, WEAKEST ON

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Anchor every claim in site, phase, context, comparison and regional variation.	VERDICT: Harappan history is strongest on material systems, weakest on named ideas.
1. Separate excavated fact from function label and social interpretation.	3. The undeciphered script limits named claims about language, rulers and doctrine.	EVIDENCE LADDER
SOURCE / MATERIAL	**METHOD / DEBATE**	**HISTORICAL RESULT**
• EVIDENCE LADDER	• 2. Anchor every claim in site, phase, context, comparison and regional variation.	• VERDICT: Harappan history is strongest on material systems, weakest on named ideas.
• 1. Separate excavated fact from function label and social interpretation.	• 3. The undeciphered script limits named claims about language, rulers and doctrine.	• EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Harappan history is strongest on material systems, weakest on named ideas.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Harappan history is strongest on material systems, weakest on named ideas.

11 EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. CITADEL, GRANARY, DOCKYARD, PRIEST-KING AND PASHUPATI ARE MODERN · 2. HORSE EVIDENCE IS RARE AND DISPUTED; STANDARDISATION DOES · 3. DEURBANISATION WAS REGIONAL AND MULTI-CAUSAL, NOT ONE INVASION · STATE THE SECURE EVIDENCE FIRST, THEN GRADE EACH INTERPRETATION.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS → 1. Citadel, granary, dockyard, Priest-King and Pashupati are modern labels. → 2. Horse evidence is rare and disputed; standardisation does not prove one empire. → 3. Deurbanisation was regional and multi-causal, not one invasion or drought. → VERDICT: State the secure evidence first, then grade each interpretation.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Citadel, granary, dockyard, Priest-King and Pashupati are modern labels.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM
- 2. Horse evidence is rare and disputed; standardisation does not prove one empire.
- 3. Deurbanisation was regional and multi-causal, not one invasion or drought.

DEBATE / LEGACY
- VERDICT: State the secure evidence first, then grade each interpretation.
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: State the secure evidence first, then grade each interpretation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State the secure evidence first, then grade each interpretation.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. DEBATES & INTERPRETATIONS (HIGH-YIELD TABLE) · GENETICS AND HARAPPAN/VEDIC QUESTIONS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · 3. STUDY LINKS · 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) · + EXACT PYQ APPLICATION (2025 GS-I) · 5. UPSC TRAPS

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Debates & interpretations (high-yield table)
- Genetics and Harappan/Vedic Questions — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

ADVANCED DEBATE
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- + Exact PYQ application (2025 GS-I)
- 5. UPSC Traps

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 7. Mains angles
- Optional Advanced Studios: Distinct Refinements — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A1. Urbanism, Households and Craft — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A2. Standardisation and Authority — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels